MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume X | Issue II + III | Special Edition



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NOW



CASTRO STREET: Past, Present, Future

JOIN US FOR OUR FIRST VIRTUAL EVENT!

Mountain View's Castro Street has undergone many transformations over the course of its 150+ year history. From the dusty dirt roadway and wooden plank sidewalks of the 1860s, to the four busy lanes of traffic, narrow sidewalks, and neon signs of the 1940s, to the Parisian-inspired revamp in 1990 that transformed Castro Street into the pedestrian-friendly destination it is today.

Today, Castro Street is undergoing another dramatic, albeit temporary, transformation in response to the COVID-19 pandemic. Physically-distanced outdoor dining has replaced vehicle traffic, offering a glimpse of what a fully-pedestrianized Castro Street might look like in the future. Join us as MVHA President Nick Perry and Gehl designer John Bela share the story of Castro Street's past, present, and future!

OUR SPEAKER


John Bela

John Bela is an urbanist and public space designer for Gehl, a design firm working to adapt Castro Street to the COVID-19 pandemic, as well as future changes related to the Caltrain grade separation. He combines a background in art, science, and environmental design to create vibrant, dynamic, and resilient urban human habitats. A pioneer in user-generated urbanism, John has successfully completed many projects that involve radical new formulations of social space. He is a senior lecturer at California College of Arts in San Francisco and a distinguished lecturer at UC Berkeley. John holds degrees in landscape architecture and environmental design, biochemistry, and sculpture.

REGISTER AT: https://mvhacastrostreet.eventbrite.com

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 6, 2020 ● 1:00 P.M. TO 2:00 P.M. ● FREE ZOOM WEBINAR

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

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www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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In Memoriam

Garrett Hammell
April 9, 2020

MVHA member & founder of: "Lost Mountain View" facebook group

News & Notes

President's Message

By Nicholas Perry
MVHA President



Frontline worker tribute at 390 Palo Alto Avenue. Thanks to Renee Scherer for sending us the photo!

Dear MVHA Members,

I hope this message finds you and your loved ones well during these challenging times. Our lives have changed dramatically since I last wrote to you here at the start of 2020. As I've noted in this column before, my family no longer lives in Mountain View and the MVHA's meetings and events have been our primary connection to our hometown. It's felt so strange to not have a MVHA-related reason to visit Mountain View for six months.

While taking this unexpected break from MV history, I've been watching history unfold from my home on the other Castro Street, in San Francisco. It was shocking to see how quickly this bustling city shutdown. The first thing we noticed was the sudden absence of the noisy Google busses that drove past our apartment on their way to Mountain View! After shelter-in-place officially began, we found hope and encouragement in daily walks spotting dozens of rainbow drawings taped to neighbors' windows. By mid-March, a new nightly ritual was in full force: At 8:00 p.m. cheers and applause for frontline workers erupted from the city's hills and valleys. And a few times, later in the night, an eerie natural callback to those cheers could be heard: the howls of coyotes (yes, coyotes!) venturing into the neighborhood, emboldened by the sudden lack of people and traffic.

Those early weeks of the pandemic felt like the entire Castro had fallen asleep and we were collectively living in a surreal dream. And then, the murder of George Floyd on May 25, and a sudden reawakening of the neighborhood in early June. Helicopters buzzed overhead, protests in support of Black Lives Matter filled Castro Street, a nightly curfew was imposed. In a non-pandemic world, I would have joined the protests. But I'm taking their message to heart. Mountain View has long prided itself for its ethnic diversity; and during my time on the MVHA Board we've made it a priority to reflect the city's diversity in our events and programs. But there's still more work to be done. I'm starting by educating myself about the local history of the Black community. Please see my article on page 3 for more information.

As we head into the fall, it's hard to predict what the future has in store. With COVID-19 still threatening us, wildfires threatening our communities, and an important election coming in November, I'm afraid the months ahead will be just as eventful as the ones we've just lived through. All of this is a long way of me getting to my main point: We are all now witnesses to what will be a defining year in history. If you live in Mountain View, consider writing down your thoughts or snapping photos that capture what life is like in your neighborhood right now. Future local historians will thank you for helping to memorialize how the events of 2020 affected the lives of the people of Mountain View. If there's anything you'd like to add to our archives, contact us!

As you've probably guessed, the MVHA has canceled all in-person events until guidance from Santa Clara County health officials indicate it will be safe to hold public gatherings again. In the meanwhile, we hope you'll stay connected with us online and that you'll join us for our first-ever virtual event on Zoom on September 6. Until then, stay healthy, be safe, and take care.

—Nick



Retro MV

MVHA's Online Clothing Shop Now Open!

Looking to add some hometown pride to your wardrobe? Then check out the MVHA's online clothing shop where we're selling designs inspired by local history! All proceeds go to supporting the MVHA and our mission to preserve and share Mountain View's history. Visit the shop at:

teespring.com/stores/retromv

Financial Report

By Emily Ramos
MVHA Treasurer

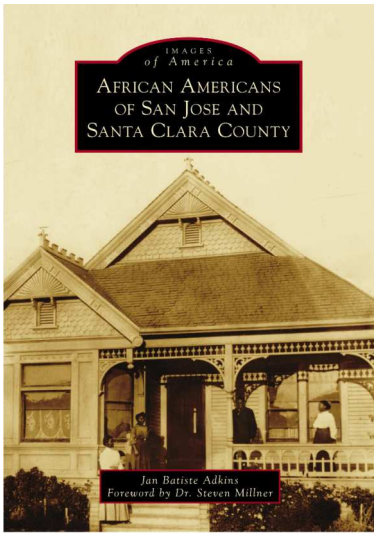
Checking Account Balance as of 1/24/2020: $22,645.86
- Income: $527.56
- Expenses: $783.13

Checking Account Balance as of 6/10/2020: $22,224.24

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 1/24/2020: $60,321.66
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 6/10/2020: $60,434.11

Black History in MV

By Nick Perry
MVHA President



The protests and movement sparked by the killing of George Floyd have compelled me to learn more about Black history in the Santa Clara Valley. Mountain View is my hometown, and my family is made up of the many ethnic groups that are deeply rooted in the city (Mexican, Portuguese, Filipino, Chinese, Japanese, and more). Although the current waves of gentrification are threatening it, the city has long taken pride in its diversity.

But Mountain View's African American population has historically been small and the history of the community is not well-chronicled. In an effort to learn more, I recently read the book *African Americans of San Jose and Santa Clara County*, written in 2019 by Jan Batiste Adkins. I highly encourage others interested in the local history of the Black community to pick up a copy of this book. It does a great job tracing African American history all the way back to the era of Spanish exploration and settlement to the present through historical images.

The book does not directly address any individuals or places linked to Mountain View, focusing primarily on historically Black communities rooted in Palo Alto and San Jose. But after reading it, I was spurred to uncover whatever history I could on Mountain View's early African American families. Some initial census research I did online shows only two Black households in Mountain View's 1920 census, two in the 1930 census, and four in the 1940 census. I've yet to research subsequent census years. World War II draft cards indicate six Black men who listed Mountain View as their home address. Mountain View High School yearbooks feature Black Student Union groups starting in the 1970s and continuing off and on into the present (see example on page 11).

Once the Mountain View History Center archives reopen, I hope these initial leads help uncover more information about the Black individuals and families that have called Mountain View home over the decades. If you have personal connections to Black history in Mountain View, please reach out. Your stories, photos, and memories can help our archives better reflect the full diversity of Mountain View. Email us at: info@mountainviewhistorical.org

Huff School Renaming

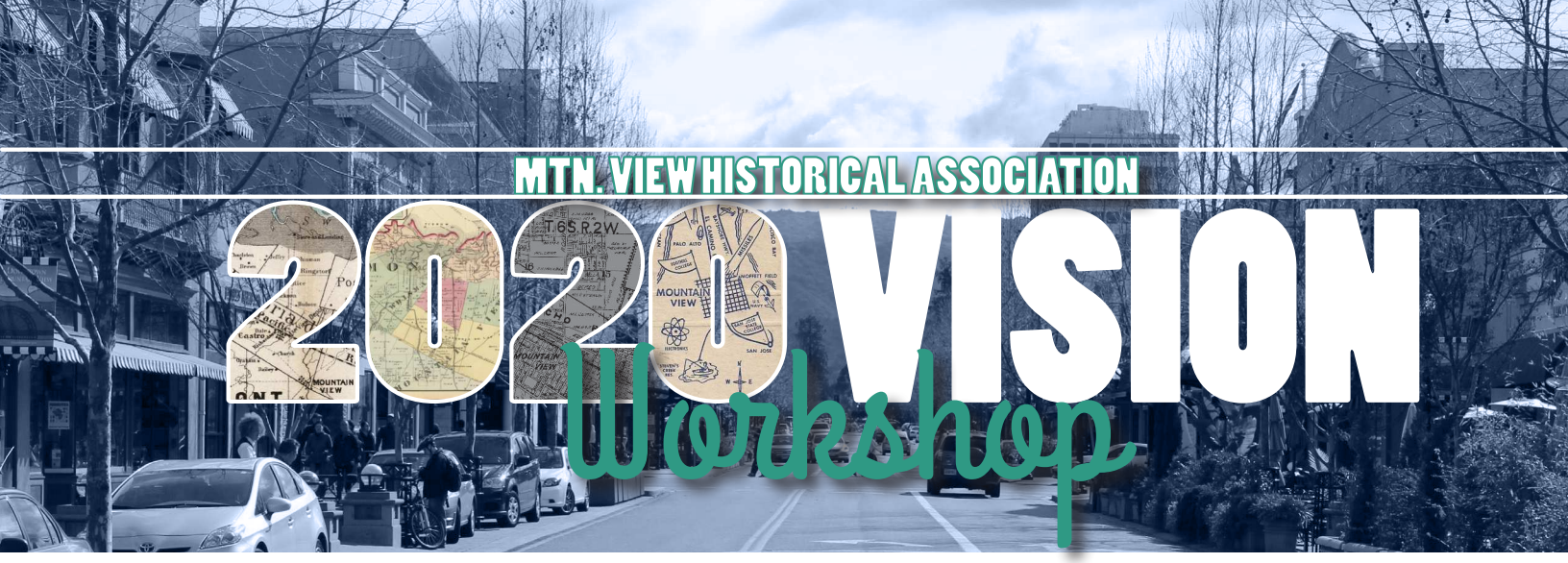
By Candace Bowers
MVHA Past President

The MVHA has been contacted by multiple members of the Huff Elementary School community about efforts to rename the school. Huff Elementary School opened in 1958 and is named after Frank L. Huff. According to newspaper accounts from the period, Mountain View School District campuses at the time were named after "pioneer citizens, retired school teachers and outstanding residents who have contributed to the advancement of education in Mountain View." Frank L. Huff was born in 1867 at his family's ranch on Charleston Road in what is now the North Bayshore district of Mountain View. He grew up to be both an orchardist and educator and served for many years as the principal of the grammar schools of Mountain View, thus meeting the school district's mid-century requirements for school naming.

However, there is growing concern that Huff's personal contribution to Mountain View history is tarnished by racist and nativist views. A circa 1922 biography of Huff written in Eugene T. Sawyer's *History of Santa Clara County, California*, notes that Huff "is strongly opposed to the immigration into our country of people who are out of harmony with American institutions and ideals, particularly those of such blood as cannot be assimilated by the Caucasian race to its benefit." To read Huff's full biography online, visit:

www.mariposaresearch.net/santaclararesearch/SCBIOS/flhuff.html.

I have combed through our archives to determine if there's any additional information on Huff that can shed further light on this troubling history. But so far, nothing more has been uncovered. The MVHA has also offered our assistance to the Huff Elementary School community in further historical research that may yield potential names of other local historical figures for a school name.



MTN. VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

2020 VISION Workshop

The MVHA's winter 2020 membership meeting served as a workshop where members came together to generate ideas for the future of the organization. The MVHA Board worked with professional mediator Michael Kasperzak to plan the workshop and its interactive exercises. The workshop took place on February 16, 2020, at the Independent Order of Odd Fellows lodge on Castro Street. Ten of the 11 MVHA board members attended, along with 12 members, a guest from the Sunnyvale Historical Society, and workshop facilitator IdaRose Sylvester. Snapshots from the workshop are below, and ideas generated during the workshop are summarized on the next page.



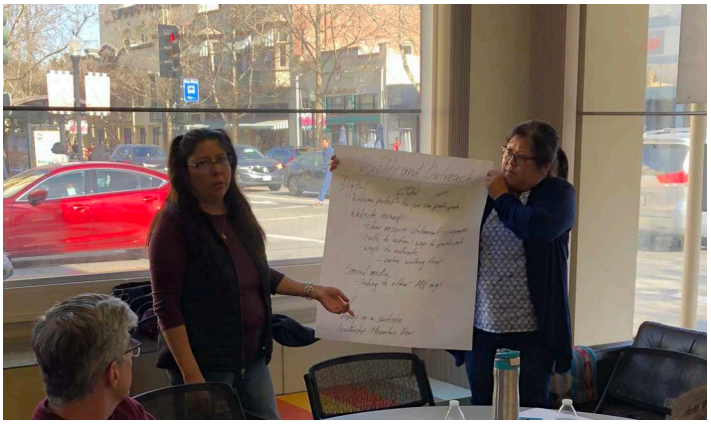
Participants wrote on construction paper up to five ideas that answered the workshop's key question, "What Should the MVHA be doing to move us forward over the coming decade?" Here, Allison Hicks (left) shares one of her ideas with the group.



To help visualize themes, overlaps, and synergies, the ideas written by participants on construction paper were adhered to a large "blue wall." With everyone's input, workshop facilitator IdaRose Sylvester sorted participants' ideas into seven broad categories.



Workshop participants broke-out into small groups, one for each of the seven categories, to further flesh-out ideas and propose discrete projects. Here, Candace Bowers writes down her group's ideas with input from Martha Wallace (left), David Salinero (right), and Gil Lane (foreground).



Each small group then took turns sharing ideas for their top projects and shared initial thoughts about project goals, measures of success, strengths the MVHA can leverage, obstacles we might face, and suggested next steps. Here, Margarete Minar (left) and Lisa Garcia share their group's ideas.



Thank you to Mike Kasperzak and IdaRose Sylvester for helping plan/facilitate our workshop, to I.O.O.F. for hosting us, and to everyone who came to share their ideas!

HIGHLIGHTS OF PROJECT IDEAS GENERATED AT THE WORKSHOP

VISIBILITY & OUTREACH

16 project ideas were generated related to programs that could increase membership and retain members. Examples include creating lectures for school outreach and developing a welcome packet for new members.

HISTORIC PRESERVATION

10 project ideas were generated related to preserving historic buildings and places. Examples include advocating for a revised historic preservation ordinance and focusing on preservation of historic downtown buildings.

ARCHIVES & COLLECTIONS

10 project ideas were generated related to preserving archival resources. Examples include focusing on collecting more archival material related to post-WWII history and modernizing the Mountain View History Center.

PUBLIC RESOURCES

9 project ideas were generated related to projects and programs that could build general public awareness of Mountain View history. Examples include developing a walking tour program, an oral history program, and historical plaque/marker program.

PARTNERSHIPS

7 project ideas were generated related to building stronger partnerships with other community organizations, and increasing membership and interest in the organization. Examples include partnerships with the MV Chamber, neighborhood associations, and local schools.

CITY COLLABORATION

4 project ideas were generated related to having closer collaboration with city government. Examples of ideas shared include (re)establishing an official city historian position and creating a historic preservation commission.

FUNDRAISING

3 project ideas were generated related to fundraising. Ideas included hiring an executive director and engaging corporations for financial support.

WHAT'S NEXT?

Although the COVID-19 pandemic slowed us a down a bit, the MVHA is excited to start turning these ideas into reality! Want to help us? Have other ideas to share? Contact us today!

Email:
info@mountainviewhistorical.org

The 1918 Flu Pandemic in MV

The ongoing COVID-19 pandemic has prompted renewed curiosity in the last major pandemic to sweep across the United States: the flu pandemic of 1918–19. The MVHA has received a few requests for information on how the 1918 "Spanish Flu" affected the lives of the people of Mountain View. Unfortunately, we have no first-hand accounts, photos, or records that dive into the details of how Mountain View residents coped with that challenging time. However, what we do have are newsletter clippings. MVHA past president and History Center librarian Candace Bowers has combed through old editions of the Mountain View Register Leader newspaper for anything related to the 1918 flu. Her discoveries are shared here. Mountain View was a small city with a population of less than 1,800 and these notices and folksy columns offer a glimpse of rural, small town life back then.

October 11, 1918

GLEN THEATRE CLOSED

In accordance with a request from the Board of Health, there will be no further performances at the Glen Theatre until further notice. This precautionary action was taken because of the reported cases of Spanish Influenza.

Just ad during current pandemic, movie theaters were some of the first businesses to close down in Mountain View during the 1918 flu. The Glen Moving Picture Theatre was located at 174 Castro Street and was built in 1910 by Fritz Campen. It was the first building in Mountain View constructed specifically for the purpose of showing moving pictures.



A photo of the Glen Theatre around the time of its grand opening in June 1910.

November 15, 1918

Local Notes

We kinda reckon there'll be a new Independence Day now—November Eleventh. Hip, hip, hurrah!

Lot of fellows around here trying to grow mustaches, but George Chickovich is the only man we know who has made a real success of it so far.

Do Americans make good soldiers? For the most conclusive answer to this question write to Mr. Wm. Hohenzollern, at present in Holland.

Heavy snowfall in the Sierras recently means plenty of water in the deep wells and irrigation ditches next year.

"Uncle Ned" Greenwood, as Mike Farrell calls him, was in here Wednesday to tell us about his pumpkins. He didn't have his mask on, but still we knew him well.

"Influenza disappears around Morgan Hill," is a headline in Wednesday's Mercury. We had noticed that it was gone, but didn't know which hill it had gone around. 'Tis well.

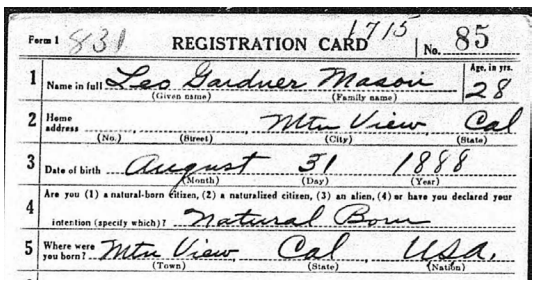
Albert Skinner, who was one of the sufferers from influenza-pneumonia, was in town Tuesday for the first time in several weeks. He had a severe attack, as did his father, but both are now well on the way to good health again.

Pretty soon people will discard the white masks and then we shall have to look upon all of those ugly faces again just as before. Why not adopt the mask as a regular article of wearing apparel, and discard something else instead?

Leo Mason writes from France that he is well and happy. He saw Harry Christensen over there, but that was the only one of the boys from here that he had met. Maurice VanDamme and Melvin Andreen are somewhere near him.

The big news in this November 1918 column was the end of World War I on November 11, but news of the flu is sprinkled throughout. A sure sign that Mountain View was still a small town in 1918: General updates on the health and whereabouts of everyday citizens were newsworthy! A joke about masks hiding ugly faces is sandwiched between updates on the lives of various citizens in this column.

A quick search on Ancestry.com confirms that the young man mentioned in the last paragraph, Leo Mason, was in France fighting in World War I. Maurice VanDamme and Melvin Andreen are likely other local boys fighting in the war. A copy of Mason's military registration card is below. It appears he survived both the war and the flu; the 1930 census shows him living at 407 Loreto Street with his wife and son.


Form 1 831 REGISTRATION CARD 1715 No. 85

1 Name in full: Leo Gardner Mason (Given name) (Family name) — Age, in yrs.: 28

2 Home address: (No.) (Street) Mtn View (City) Cal (State)

3 Date of birth: August (Month) 31 (Day) 1888 (Year)

4 Are you (1) a natural-born citizen, (2) a naturalized citizen, (3) an alien, (4) or have you declared your intention (specify which)? Natural Born

5 Where were you born? Mtn View (Town) Cal (State) USA. (Nation)

December 20, 1918

MUST WEAR MASKS

Board of Health Takes Measures to Stamp Out the Influenza Epidemic In Mountain View

There has been an average of about forty cases of influenza each week for three weeks, counting all cases and including severe colds. Only one or two cases have developed into pneumonia, and all the rest have been of a very light form.

But there is still much to be feared from the disease, and the Board of Health has decided that more drastic measures must be adopted if the epidemic is to be stamped out of this community. Consequently at a meeting on Wednesday evening the following order was made:

IMPORTANT

ALL PERSONS COMING IN CONTACT WITH THE PUBLIC, SUCH AS BARBERS, CLERKS, ETC., AND ALL PERSONS ATTENDING PUBLIC GATHERINGS, SUCH AS CHURCHES, THEATRES, LODGE MEETINGS AND THE PUBLIC LIBRARY, SHALL WEAR MASKS UNTIL FURTHER NOTICE.

By Order of
THE BOARD OF HEALTH

NOTICE TO THE CITIZENS OF MOUNTAIN VIEW

At a meeting of the Board of Health of the Town of Mountain View, held on this 18th day of December, the question of stopping the influenza was thoroughly discussed, and it was decided that, rather than order the closing of all public places, stores, etc., at present, the above Order was adopted, and we ask your sincere and earnest cooperation in order that the above Order may be carried out, and we make the following suggestions:

1st. Report all cases of influenza to the Board of Health or Board of Town Trustees.

2nd. Keep away from crowds and public gathering places as much as possible and keep the children at home.

3rd. All influenza patients should be isolated from the rest of the family if possible, and after they are up and about they should wear the mask for at least ten days.

by order
BOARD OF HEALTH.

NOTICE TO THE CITIZENS OF MOUNTAIN VIEW

Mountain View citizens were ordered to wear masks until further notice by the town's Board of Health in December 1918. Then, as now, masks were viewed as the best tool for protecting the population against further spread of the virus, while still allowing public places to remain open.

LOUIS BIDOVICH

Mr. Louis Bidovich (sometimes called Vidovich) died late Thursday evening at his home on Bryant avenue, of pneumonia, following influenza. Mr. Bidovich leaves a wife, Mrs. Annie Bidovich, a sister, Mrs. L. Stonovich and a brother Vincent, to mourne his passing. He was 36 years of age and a native of Dalmatia, Austria. The funeral will be private, from the parlors of A. W. Nuttman, in Santa Clara.

Louis Vidovich's obituary offers a glimpse into the local toll the flu pandemic had on the people of Mountain View. Mr. Vidovich (also spelled Bidovich) passed away on December 19, 1918, at the age of 36, leaving his wife, Annie, a widow. His World War I draft registration card lists him as an orchardist living in a rural area just outside of Mountain View.

January 10, 1919

SCHOOLS REOPENED

General Health Conditions Very Good —Trained Nurse Employed to Watch for Disease Symptoms

The Mountain View public schools reopened last Monday under the supervision of Professor Hester, superintendent of the high, and Mr. Slater, principal of the grammar schools. The attendance was very good. The district has employed a trained nurse who is right on hand every day to examine the children for any symptoms of disease. On Monday no child was found with smptoms of disease, consequently none was sent home; and on Wednesday two children were sent home.

The plan is to send home any child that shows any indication of disease whatever, or any child coming from a home in which it is known that there is disease. Consequently the parents and patrons of the schools generally can be of the greatest assistance to the faculty by cooperating in this way. If there is sickness in the family or the home, do not send any child from that home to school until all members of the household are entirely well. If this is done the disease can be overcome very quickly; otherwise the disease may continue in the community indefinitely, and it might become necessary to close the schools again.

Professor Hester is well pleased and greatly encouraged with the present conditions in the schools as regards health and attendance. He found these conditions better than he had hoped for, in fact.

The Seventh-Day Adventist parochial school has been open right along. They have a nurse most all the time, and so far, there has been no disease, particularly influenza, in the school.

If all of the people will do what they can to help the health department and the nurses in the schools, the epidemic will soon be a thing of the past in Mountain View. In fact this community has been more fortunatet than many others in that regard. Our percentage of deaths from influenza causes has been very low comparatively.

Miss Edith M. Burdick is the nurse employed. She appears to be a very capable person, and deeply interested in her work. Where she finds a child with the symptoms of disease she immediately investigates the family and if there is sickness in the family of a communicable sort, the children are kept out of the school until two weeks after all disease has been eliminated from the family.

By January 1919, the pandemic had waned enough to allow Mountain View's public schools to reopen. This article outlines the procedures put in place to protect school children, including the employment of Ms. Edith Burdick as an on-site nurse to screen children for symptoms of the flu at the start of each day. The article also notes:

"If all of the people will do what they can to help the health department and the nurses in the schools, the epidemic will soon be a thing of the past in Mountain View. In fact this community has been more fortunate than most others in that regard. Our percentage of deaths from influenza causes has been very low, comparatively."

Let's hope the same can be written after the current pandemic has ended. Take care, everyone!



Mtn. View High School in 1919

Fraternal Organizations

Contributing to MV's History for Generations

By Jerry Steach
MVHA Member

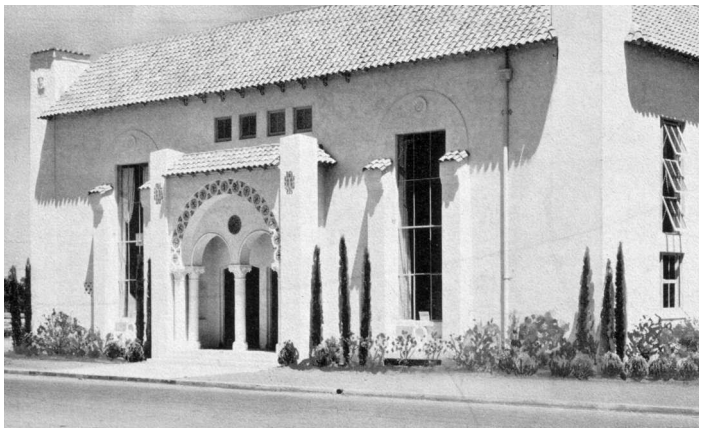
Editor's Note: *This article was originally published in the May 2020 issue of the Old Mountain View Neighborhood Association Newsletter, and has been expanded for MVHA reading.*

Often going unnoticed in Mountain View is the work of fraternal groups that for generations have quietly gone about performing noble deeds, locally and beyond. There's a rich heritage in the city of not-for-profit organizations such as the Eagles, Freemasons, Kiwanis, Odd Fellows, Rotary Club, and Sociedade da Festa Velha do Divino Espirito Santo (SFV). Many of them are based in historically significant buildings–some nearly a hundred years old.

The Fraternal Order of Eagles Aerie 2356, has occupied three different locations on the historic 100 block of Castro Street since it was chartered in 1946. The aerie (lodge) originally met in the Jurian Building, built in 1913 at the corner of Villa and Castro streets. It then relocated across and down the street to where Olympus Caffe & Bakery is now. The order later purchased the property of its present location a few doors away, which was the original Meyer Electric (later Meyer Appliance) site. That building was destroyed by a fire in 2002 but soon rebuilt to its present form, using more contemporary architecture. Founded in the 1890s, the Eagles organization is guided by its motto, "People Helping People," reflected in Aerie 2356's ongoing support of local and national causes, including Mountain View Police Department–sponsored community programs, the Community Services Agency, and national charities such as the National Diabetes Fund and St. Jude's Hospital. For more information, see: https://bit.ly/3bpgKcJ .



A c. 1950 parade passes 181 Castro Street, then the location of Les Wright Appliances and now occupied by the Eagles Aerie 2356.



Mountain View's Masonic Lodge on Church Street was originally built in 1932 as the American Legion Memorial Hall.

The Freemasons' Mountain View De Anza Lodge 194, located on Church Street adjacent to Pioneer Park, was built in 1932 originally for the American Legion, and purchased three years later by the Freemasons. Designed in the Spanish Eclectic architectural style, it's changed little. The building presently hosts Lodge 194's meetings, while its downstairs can be rented by the public for various events. Lodge members, following the Freemasons' stated mission to foster personal growth and improve the lives of others, support the Mountain View community by donating their time and resources to causes such as music and the arts for local public schools. For more information, see: https://bit.ly/3fDwjRf .



Kiwanis Club members and Mtn. View High athletes pose for a group photo in front of the Adobe Building in 1937.

Founded in 1926 to fund the purchase land for Scout troops, **Kiwanis Club of Mountain View** remains active in supporting charities and nonprofits throughout the city and neighboring communities. Over the past two decades, the Kiwanis have donated more than two million dollars to the Mountain View community, in the form of school supplies; college scholarships; and grants to programs serving youth sports, education, the arts, child and adult care, local parks, and other charities. Instead of operating from their own building, the Mountain View Kiwanis meet twice monthly at Don Giovanni's restaurant downtown. For more information, see: https://bit.ly/2AwU4dQ .

Article continues on next page.

The Independent Order of Odd Fellows – Mountain View Lodge #244 is located at the corner of Castro and Villa streets in a 1909 building that was originally a First National Bank branch and whose facade once sported grand, two-story columns (see photo on right). The Odd Fellows in 1970 purchased the building, which to this day retains much of its original look inside and out. The lodge holds regular public events that encourage fledgling writers and hosts gender-diverse groups, as well as crafts fairs that support Rebeka Children's Services and an annual Halloween haunted house. For more information, see: https://bit.ly/3dya8dw .





I.O.O.F's first home in Mtn. View was the circa 1876 Enterprise Hall on El Camino Real (left). Later, the I.O.O.F. was located in the circa 1906 Mockbee Building on Castro Street (above).

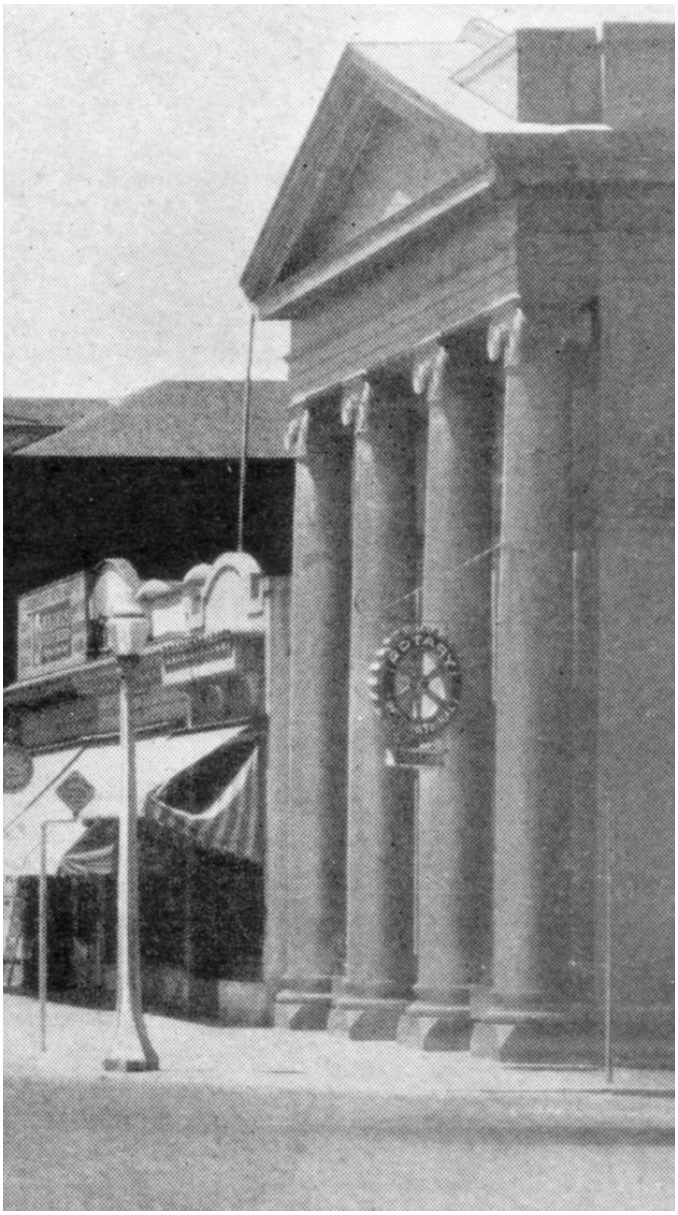


SFV Holy Ghost festa in 1953. (Credit: Madeline Borges)



IFES Members in 1937 (Credit: IFES)

What locals commonly refer to as the Portuguese Hall on Villa Street near Calderon Avenue is actually a complex of **Sociedade de Festa Velha (SFV)–**owned buildings. The SFV shares its origins with Mountain View's other Portuguese fraternal organization, the **Irmandade da Festa do Espírito Santo (IFES)**, on Stierlin Road. Both SFV and IFES trace their founding to a traditional Portuguese "Festa do Espírito Santo" celebration, first held in Mountain View in 1926, at the John and Jose Ferreira Costa dairy on Charleston Road. The Spanish Eclectic –style SFV complex was built in 1937—before Villa Street was even extended to run in front of it. The SFV facilities include a banquet hall, dance hall, kitchen, and chapel. The halls are rented for weddings and other events, as well as being used for SFV's own fundraising dinners that support disaster-relief programs and building churches. For more information, see: https://bit.ly/2xWOXmm .



This circa 1925 photo shows the Rotary Club's sign projecting from the columns of the First National Bank Building on Castro Street. The building has been home to the I.O.O.F. since the 1970s.

The Rotary Club of Mountain View, chartered in 1924, is part of a worldwide organization supporting educational, cultural, and humanitarian projects locally and internationally. Like the Kiwanis, the Rotarians don't operate out of their own building in Old Mountain View but instead meet at the Historic Adobe Building, on Moffett Boulevard, at which speakers from diverse civic, political, and business backgrounds give presentations to members and guests. More information on the Rotarians can be found here: https://bit.ly/3coh1hr .

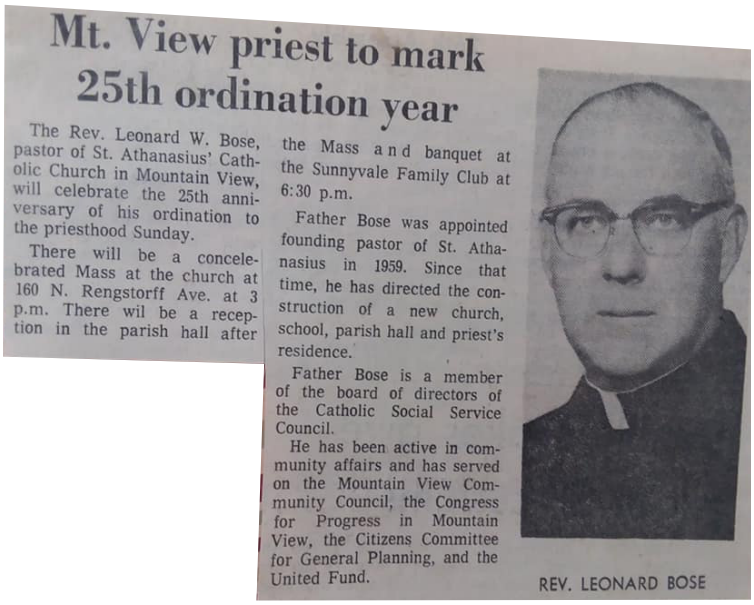
The process of joining these fraternal organizations varies; some organizations have straightforward applications, whereas others require referrals by members. Applicants are screened before being accepted, and each organization has some form of membership fees. It's recommended that anyone interested in joining one of these organizations contact them directly.

MV Q&A

Due to shelter-in-place, the MVHA had to cancel all of our in-person events over the past six months. To help make up for it, we turned our Facebook page into an on-going Q&A session on Mountain View history. Some highlights are shared below! Join the conversation at: facebook.com/MVHistory .

Lucas R. shared the newspaper clipping below and asked:

Q: *"What was the "Mountain View Community Council"?"*



Mt. View priest to mark 25th ordination year

The Rev. Leonard W. Bose, pastor of St. Athanasius' Catholic Church in Mountain View, will celebrate the 25th anniversary of his ordination to the priesthood Sunday.

There will be a concelebrated Mass at the church at 160 N. Rengstorff Ave. at 3 p.m. There wil be a reception in the parish hall after the Mass and banquet at the Sunnyvale Family Club at 6:30 p.m.

Father Bose was appointed founding pastor of St. Athanasius in 1959. Since that time, he has directed the construction of a new church, school, parish hall and priest's residence.

Father Bose is a member of the board of directors of the Catholic Social Service Council.

He has been active in community affairs and has served on the Mountain View Community Council, the Congress for Progress in Mountain View, the Citizens Committee for General Planning, and the United Fund.

REV. LEONARD BOSE

A:

Father Leonard Bose was founding pastor of St. Athanasius Catholic Church of Mountain View and a member of the "Mountain View Community Council," a former name of the Community Services Agency (CSA) in Mountain View. The CSA's website (www.csacares.org/about-csa/history/) nicely summarizes the organization's history. Here's an excerpt that explains the name changes over the years:

"CSA has grown from humble origins. In 1957, a group of Mountain View residents, concerned about the welfare of low-income families in the city, gathered to talk about the plight of the local migrant farm workers. They decided to form the Mountain View Welfare Council to address the needs of this population. Within a year, the council was incorporated, and it was planning its first sharing of holiday gifts for families.

By 1967, the interests of the council had expanded to include housing issues, immigration issues, and the needs of senior citizens. Accordingly, its name was changed to the Mountain View Community Council.

With a move into larger, permanent office space in 1974, the organization changed its name once again, this time to Mountain View Community Services, reflecting the increasing services provided, such as meals and counseling.

CSA assumed its present name, Community Services Agency, in 1982, in recognition of a client base that extends through Los Altos to Los Altos Hills."

As we make our way through the current crisis, let's find inspiration in the CSA's history and remember to look out for one another, and especially for those who are most vulnerable in these challenging times. We're all in this together.

Renee S. asked:

Q: *"We just moved into 990 California (renters)—some parts are in great (original?) condition! Can you tell us more about this house's history?"*

A:

990 California Street was the home of Elbert (aka Bert) Zivley Hitchcock and Mary Hitchcock, built c. 1905. You can see the couple pictured here in the older, circa 1915, photo. We couldn't find much information about Bert in our digital archives, but we were able to learn more about Mary. Mary came from a prominent Irish family with deep roots in Mountain View. Her father was James Campbell, who came to Mountain View from Ireland in 1862. James married Margaret Leornard Burke, also a native of Ireland, in Mountain View. For 16 years they were tenant ranchers at the Hale Ranch in modern-day Los Altos where they grew grain and raised stock. They later moved to San Mateo County and continued ranching.

In 1890 the couple returned to Mountain View and built a home at 394 Franklin Street (the house still stands today). Mary was one of their 10 children. Mary married Elbert on March 4, 1901. The couple had a daughter who passed away at a very young age. We've been waiting to get permission to use a historic photo we found of Mary and Bert sitting inside the house's living room from a private collection, but haven't heard back from the owner yet. If we do get permission, we'll follow up with more photos!



990 California Street c.

Jill H. saw our response and replied:

"They are related to me—my uncle lived in the home until his death—I loved going inside, it was like a mansion to me!"



990 California Street circa 1977

Membership Report

By Lisa Garcia
Membership Chair

Membership as of August 1, 2020

Honored Members	1
Life Members	117
Family Members	65
Single Members	73
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**256**

Thank you to Jeff Sato for becoming a Lifetime member!

A warm welcome to our new members:

Nazanin Dashtara, Louise Katz, Nancy Lehmicke, Alex Nunez, Brooke Ray Smith, Karen & Jerry Steach, Eric Tipton, and Jean Weston



Volunteer Opportunities

The MVHA welcomes members interested in lending their time and talent. Interested? Questions? Email us at info@mountainviewhistorical.org or leave us a voicemail at (650) 903-6890.

MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! By becoming a member, you are making a special investment in our mission to preserve and share Mountain View history with the community, conserve priceless archival materials at the History Center, and hold memorable public events throughout the year. You can also join and renew online at **www.mountainviewhistorical.org**. Please support the MVHA, and join us today!

☐ New Membership

☐ Membership Renewal

☐ Single Membership: *$15/year*

☐ Family Membership: *$25/year*

☐ Life Membership: *$200*

Name(s): _____

Street Address: _____

City: _____

State: _____ Zip Code: _____

Telephone: _____

E-mail: _____

☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

☐ *I'd like a print-edition subscription of the newsletter. (To save paper and costs, the default subscription is digital emailed newsletter.)*

Please make checks payable to:
Mtn. View Historical Association

Mail this form to:
Mountain View Historical Association
c/o Lisa Garcia
P.O. Box 252
Mtn. View, CA 94042

Thank you!

SUMMER/FALL

September 6
Sunday, 1:00 p.m. to 2:00 p.m.
MVHA Spring + Summer Meeting: Castro Street, Past Present, Future
Virtual Zoom meeting
See page 1 for more info.

September 9
Wednesday, 5:30 p.m. to 7:30 p.m.
MVHA Summer/Fall Board Meeting
Virtual Zoom meeting
All interested members welcome to attend! Email info@mountainviewhistorical.org for log-in

November 1
Sunday, 1:00 p.m. to 3:00 p.m.
MVHA Fall Event & Meeting
Virtual Zoom meeting
Details in our next newsletter!

December 9
Wednesday, 5:30 p.m. to 7:30 p.m.
MVHA Fall/Winter Board Meeting
Virtual Zoom meeting
All interested members welcome to attend!

Looking Back: Photos from the Archive



Members of the 1977–78 Black Student Union at Mountain View High School on Castro Street

In the 1970s, Mountain View High School on Castro Street was known for its racial diversity. Although the Black population of the school was small compared to other racial groups, it was large enough to support a Black Student Union (BSU) throughout the decade. In the 1977–78 school year, the BSU members pictured here organized a Black History Week that included speeches, poetry readings, a musical performance, and a fashion show. When the school closed in 1981, the reassignment of its students to Los Altos High School and the "new" Mountain View (formerly Awalt) High School led to the establishment of Black Student Unions on both campuses for the first time in the 1981–82 school year.

EST. 1954
MOUNTAIN REVIEW
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042
WEB: www.mountainviewhistorical.org
EMAIL: info@mountainviewhistorical.org

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